THE BECOMING INSTITUTE

OFFICIAL COURSE WORKBOOK

PERSONAL ADAPTABILITY

8 Ways to Thrive in a World of Constant Change

Those who cannot change their minds cannot change anything.

PERSONAL DEVELOPMENT

COURSE WORKBOOK

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INTRODUCTION

Carol Dweck's landmark research, featured in this course, established the concept of the Growth Mindset — the belief that abilities, intelligence, and character can be developed through dedication and hard work. This single belief is the foundation of personal adaptability.

The world is changing at exponential speed. Job roles are disappearing and being created within single decades. The skill of adapting — learning to learn, recovering from disruption, and evolving under pressure — is no longer optional. It is the meta-skill. This workbook trains it.

THE 8 WAYS — FRAMEWORK OVERVIEW

1. **Embrace the Growth Mindset**
   Replace "I can't do this" with "I can't do this YET." The word yet changes everything.
2. **Develop Cognitive Flexibility**
   Train your brain to hold multiple perspectives simultaneously and switch between frameworks quickly.
3. **Build Emotional Resilience**
   Resilience is not the absence of pain. It is the ability to absorb, recover, and grow from setbacks.
4. **Master Stress as a Resource**
   Kelly McGonigal's research shows that viewing stress as energising rather than harmful changes its biological effect.
5. **Accelerate Your Learning Speed**
   The Feynman Technique, spaced repetition, and deliberate practice are the tools of fast learners.
6. **Build Bounce-Back Capacity**
   Every failure is data. Build the habit of post-mortems, not regret.
7. **Develop Habit Architecture**
   Sustainable adaptability is built on consistent daily habits — not episodic motivation.
8. **Think in Scenarios**
   Model multiple possible futures. Prepare for them. Stay flexible in execution.

GROWTH MINDSET — THE ROOT OF ALL ADAPTABILITY

Carol Dweck identified two fundamental orientations toward challenge:

Fixed Mindset: Intelligence and ability are fixed traits. Effort is pointless if you lack natural talent. Challenges are threats to your identity. Failure means you are not enough.

Growth Mindset: Intelligence and ability are developable. Effort is the path to mastery. Challenges are where growth happens. Failure is information, not identity.

The implications are staggering. Students with a growth mindset consistently outperform those with fixed mindsets over time — even when starting from lower ability levels. This is because they keep trying, keep improving, and keep learning from failure.

- Praise effort and strategy, not talent: "You worked so hard on that" not "You're so smart."
- When you hit a wall, ask: "What strategy haven't I tried yet?"
- Audit your fixed beliefs: "I'm not good with numbers" — says who? Based on what evidence?

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Identify one area where you have a Fixed Mindset. What would change if you shifted to Growth?

Name one skill you believe you cannot develop. What would you need to try for 30 days to test that belief?

RESILIENCE ARCHITECTURE — BOUNCING FORWARD, NOT JUST BACK

Angela Duckworth's research on Grit — featured in this course section — demonstrates that the most successful people are not those who never fail. They are those who persist through failure longer than everyone else.

The Becoming Institute defines resilience not as "bouncing back" but as "bouncing forward" — using adversity as upgrade material.

The 4 Components of Resilience:
1. Connection: Strong relationships are the single greatest predictor of recovery from adversity.
2. Wellness: Sleep, movement, and nutrition are not lifestyle choices — they are performance infrastructure.
3. Healthy Thinking: Challenge catastrophising. "This is unbearable" vs "This is difficult and I can handle difficult."
4. Meaning: People who believe their suffering has purpose recover faster and more completely.

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Describe a past setback that made you stronger. What specifically did you gain from it?

What is one challenge you are currently facing that you can reframe as growth material?

THE FEYNMAN TECHNIQUE — ACCELERATED LEARNING FOR RAPID ADAPTATION

Richard Feynman, Nobel Prize-winning physicist, developed a learning method that produces understanding 4-6x faster than traditional study:

Step 1: Choose a concept and write it at the top of a blank page.
Step 2: Explain it as if you are teaching it to a 12-year-old. Use simple language only.
Step 3: Identify the gaps. Where did you get stuck or vague?
Step 4: Return to source material for those gaps only.
Step 5: Simplify and use analogies until you can explain it fluently.

Why it works: The act of explaining forces you to truly understand — not just recognise. Most people confuse familiarity with knowledge.

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

Apply the Feynman Technique to one concept from this course. Write your simplified explanation here:

What learning habit will you build this month using this technique?

SCENARIO THINKING — PREPARING FOR MULTIPLE FUTURES

Royal Dutch Shell pioneered scenario planning in the 1970s. By preparing for multiple possible futures rather than predicting a single outcome, they navigated the 1973 oil crisis far better than competitors who had bet on one trajectory.

Personal Scenario Planning:
1. Identify a major uncertainty in your professional or personal life.
2. Identify the 2 most critical drivers of that uncertainty.
3. Build 4 scenarios (2x2 matrix) based on those drivers.
4. Prepare a response strategy for each scenario.
5. Identify signals that indicate which scenario is unfolding.
6. Act flexibly based on incoming signals — not on a single fixed prediction.

REFLECTION & APPLICATION

What is the biggest uncertainty you face in the next 12 months? Map 3 possible scenarios:

What skill would make you resilient across ALL 3 of those scenarios? Start building it now.

30-DAY TRANSFORMATION PRACTICE PLAN

Week 1 — Mindset Reset

- Day 1-3: Track your fixed mindset moments. Write "YET" next to every limitation.
- Day 4-5: Use the Feynman Technique on one new concept daily.
- Day 6-7: Recall 3 past "failures" that were actually growth experiences.

Week 2 — Resilience Building

- Day 8-10: Establish one daily resilience ritual (sleep, movement, reflection).
- Day 11-12: Practice reframing one challenging situation per day.
- Day 13-14: Identify and contact one key relationship in your support network.

Week 3 — Learning Acceleration

- Day 15-17: Apply the Feynman Technique to one skill you want to develop.
- Day 18-19: Use spaced repetition to review material from earlier in this course.
- Day 20-21: Teach one concept from this course to someone else.

Week 4 — Strategic Flexibility

- Day 22-25: Map 3 possible scenarios for one major life uncertainty.
- Day 26-28: Identify and begin building the skill that protects you across all scenarios.
- Day 29-30: Write your Adaptability Declaration — who you are committed to becoming.

MY TRANSFORMATION COMMITMENT

My single most important goal from this course:

Three specific actions I will take in the next 7 days:

How I will measure my progress:

Signature: _____ Date: _____

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This workbook accompanies the "8 Ways to Build Personal Adaptability" course on the Origin platform.

This workbook is your practical companion for transformational learning. Every framework, worksheet, and reflection exercise has been designed to move you from insight to action — from knowing to becoming.

The Becoming Institute believes that education is not a destination — it is a daily practice. Carry this workbook with you. Return to it. Complete the exercises. Discuss them with your accountability partner. Teach them to someone else.

This is not just a guide. This is your blueprint.

Continue your journey at www.origin.com.ng

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